INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, NOTE PAD, SPRING-BACK

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of aluminum, spring-back binder, suitable for firm retention of size 8½ x 11 inch, or smaller, sheets of paper.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

QQ-A-250/2 -- Aluminum Alloy 3003, Plate and sheet.
PPP-B-566 -- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 -- Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 -- Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 -- Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 -- Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-A-8625 -- Anodic Coatings, for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 -- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 -- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 7510

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Commercial tolerances shall apply on all material gages and thicknesses specified herein.

3.1.1 Aluminum. Aluminum used in the construction of the binder shall be in accordance with QQ-A-250/2, temper H14 or H24, and shall be 0.051-inch thick.

3.1.2 Corrosion resisting steel wire.

3.1.2.1 Hinge pins. Wire used for hinge pins shall be any of the American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI) 400 series.

3.1.2.2 Springs. Wire used for springs shall be AISI 301 or 302, spring-temper (full-hard), and shall be 0.065-inch in diameter (16 gage).

3.2 Design and construction. The binder shall be end opening (binder hinge located at the width-end) and shall consist of a front cover, a binder-hinge section, a back cover, 2 hinge pins, and 3 binder-hinge springs. The binder shall be designed so that the front cover is capable of opening and closing while 1 sheet or a number of sheets of paper up to 1/2 inch in total thickness remains firmly secured, by pressure exerted by the binder-hinge springs, between the front-cover hinge and the back cover. Hereinafter, the edge of the binder equipped with the binder hinge will be referred to as the top edge, and the side opposite referred to as the bottom edge.

3.2.1 Front cover. The front cover shall be formed from one piece of polished aluminum, 10-1/2 inches ± 1/8 inch long (including curved hinge knuckles) by 9 inches ± 1/8 inch wide. The bottom edge of the front cover shall overlap a minimum distance of 1/8 inch beyond the back cover of the binder. An overlap of 1/16 inch is acceptable provided the back cover has a thumb notch at its bottom-center edge. Eight parallel embossed ridges, approximately 1 inch long, spaced approximately 3/4 inch apart, and vertically located on the front cover shall be provided for reinforcement. The tops of the ridges shall be located on a horizontal plane 1/2 to 1 inch below the front-cover hinge.

3.2.2 Binder-hinge section. The binder-hinge section shall be formed from polished aluminum and shall run the full width of the binder. The binder-hinge section shall be designed to separate the binder hinge from the front-cover hinge by a distance of approximately 1 inch.

3.2.3 Back cover. The back cover shall be formed from one piece of polished aluminum, 11-3/4 inches ± 1/8 inch long (including curved hinge knuckles) by 9 inches ± 1/8 inch wide.

3.2.4 Hinges. The 2 hinges shall be of the piano type, running parallel to each other the full width of the binder. Hinge pins shall be adequately secured to prevent removal.

3.2.4.1 Binder hinge. The binder hinge shall be formed from the top edge of the back cover and the top edge of the binder-hinge section. The hinge knuckles shall be curved around a steel hinge pin (see 3.1.2) with a 1/4-inch nominal diameter. The binder hinge shall be equipped with 3 coiled torsion springs (see 3.1.2), each approximately 1 inch long, and interspaced proportionally. The tension of the springs shall be adjusted in such a manner that the bottom of the binder-hinge section (front-cover hinge) shall press firmly against the back cover. The binder hinge shall open or expand sufficiently, when covers are bent back toward a parallel position, to permit insertion and removal of papers up to the capacity of the binder (from 1 sheet to a 1/2-inch thickness of sheets of paper). The hinge pin of the binder hinge shall be flush on each side.

3.2.4.2 Front-cover hinge. The front-cover hinge shall consist of 18 knuckles, 9 on the top edge of the front cover and 9 on the bottom edge of the binder-hinge section. The 18 knuckles shall be curved around a steel hinge pin (see 3.1.2) with a diameter of 0.083 inch (14 gage).

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3.2.5 Lock opening. When specified (see 6.2), a lock opening shall be provided. The opening shall be a 1/4-inch diameter hole through both the front and back covers, centered 3/8 inch from the bottom of the front cover and 3 inches from the left side.

3.3 Finish. After being fabricated and prior to assembly, all aluminum parts, including edges, shall be cleaned, etched, and anodized to give a type II coating (water rinsed dried) in accordance with MIL-A-8625. The finish shall produce a hard, smudgeproof surface, capable of providing adequate protection against corrosion.

3.4 Identification marking. Each binder shall be legibly and permanently die stamped on the outside of the back cover with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The die stamping shall not penetrate the opposite side of the metal.

3.5 Workmanship. The finished binders shall be free of cracks, holes, ripples, scratches, mar marks, dents, chips, sharp edges, burrs, or any other defects which detract from their appearance, constitute a personal hazard, or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and inspection.

4.2.1 Visual examination. Sample binders shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one binder. The lot size shall be all binders offered for inspection at one time.

Table I. Classification of visual defects.

Examine	Defects
Materials	Front cover, back cover, or binder hinge section not of polished aluminum; not thickness specified.
Design and construction	Binder not end-opening; not complete with all component parts; jams when opened or closed; front cover not capable of opening and closing while a single sheet or a number of sheets of paper up to 1/2-inch in total thickness remains firmly secured; covers do not bend back toward a parallel position to permit insertion and removal of papers up to the capacity of the binder.
	Front or back cover not formed from one piece of aluminum sheeting.
	Front cover not suitably embossed for reinforcement (see 3.2.1).
	Binder-hinge section not full width of binder; does not separate binder hinge from front-cover hinge by approximately 1 inch.
	Hinges not of piano type; not full width of binder; not parallel to each other.
	Hinge pins not adequately secured.

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Table I. Classification of visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defects
	Binder hinge not equipped with 3 coiled torsion springs proportionally interspaced; springs not adjusted so that front-cover hinge presses firmly against back cover; hinge pin not flush on each side.
	Front-cover hinge not complete with 18 knuckles.
	Dimensions not as specified.
	Lock opening, if requested, not as specified (see 6.2).
Finish	Not as specified in 3.3.
Identification marking	Not as specified in 3.4.
Workmanship	Not as specified in 3.5.

4.2.2 Preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Six (6) binders arranged in a reverse order shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. Kraft paper separators shall be inserted between each binder.

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5.1.2 Level B. The binders shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The binders shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of binders in quantities as specified (see 6.2) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Ten (10) unit packages of binders shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The binders shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers at the lowest rates complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard packaging (civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2, respectively.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The binder covered by this specification is intended to firmly hold filing papers or records that can be readily inserted and removed. This item is similar to the aluminum clinical chart holder covered by GG-H-555, but is intended for office and general utility use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) If lock opening is required (see 3.2.5).
(c) Quantity of unit packages required in shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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